



THIIIRD



Image by Silvia Draz / Thiiirdmagazine.co.uk

Component 2, Section C: Media in the Online Age

Focus areas:

- ♦ Media language
- ♦ Representation
- ♦ Media industries
- ♦ Media audiences
- ♦ Media contexts

Product context

THIIIRD is an independent fashion, arts and culture magazine, available in print and online, with its own podcast and seasonal events series. It offers an inclusive

platform for those social groups that tend to be overlooked by the mainstream media. THIIIRD's strapline describes it as an **'Intersectional magazine celebrating culture, diversity and heritage – KEEP YOUR THIRD EYE OPEN.'** Foregrounding the principle that the personal is political, THIIIRD is an activist fashion magazine that offers a safe space for creative people from marginalised groups to take the stage, showcase their work and to discuss issues that matter to them in their own terms.

*'On glossy mag pages, over the radio and through events, we centralise the thought, being and art of people of colour, queer, trans and non-binary people and others with underrepresented backgrounds.'*¹

Rhona Ezuma, the editor-in-chief, founded the magazine in 2017. Rhona is of Black British Nigerian heritage and was born and brought up in London. After graduating from The University of Manchester with a degree in English, she worked in mainstream publishing as a journalist, fashion stylist and costume designer, where she realised that many social groups were left out.

THIIIRD exists not just to counter the narrow beauty ideals of white dominated mainstream magazine culture, with its tokenistic nods to race and class in its workforce, but to provide new opportunities and act as a hub for a community of artists and activists to bring about social change for the future.

THIIIRD is informed by critical theory and explicitly defines its uniqueness in the magazine marketplace by implicit reference to the ideas of Paul Gilroy and bell hooks. As stated in their manifesto: *'The ethos*

¹ <https://www.thiiirdmagazine.co.uk/about>